

will be the way kids finally get cell phones into schools...

MANUFACTURING

When we say manufacturing, we mean specifically anything design related. Imagine how easier life would be as a designer if you could manipulate 3D models in real-time but on an existing base. So here's a basic design for a robot, now build creatively on it, and be able to make it animate and run to see if you got the balance all wrong. Some may even imagine the assembly of items that are done by hand, or parts where humans assist robots such as on car assembly lines, where the human could look through a HMD and be shown the sequence of assembly, and also what goes where.

DECOR

This one's a no brainer. How many times have you bought furniture and then gone, damn, I thought it was bigger / smaller. If you haven't done that, then you've certainly sweated it out moving stuff around a room trying to find a better and fresher layout for all your stuff. Those of you with significant others have heard the words, "Let's move that sofa against this wall, put the dining table (which weighs a ton and a half) the other side of the room, and bring that large cupboard to this side..." Trust us, AR is excellent for saving time with such stuff.

Not just that, wondering how your house would look if you painted the big

wall like a black and white chess board? Or maybe you're thinking about buying these lovely deep purple satin curtains, but are worried how they'd go with the furniture... Why sit around and Photo-shop, when you can see it AR-ed?

TOURIST STUFF

Go see the Taj, but be given the tour by an actor pretending to be Shah Jahan... Walk down London, and see how the London Bridge changed several times to arrive at its current look... See the great Pyramids and the Sphinx, but not in their 2000+ year old state, but as they looked brand new... just overlaid on what you're looking at in reality... Walk through the Louvre, but with your own personal virtual guide, and little virtual tags on every display piece that give you more information. The personal guide will speak your native tongue with a terrible French accent, obviously, for authenticity.

ARCHAEOLOGY

Imagine digging to uncover, say, an ancient building, but being able to overlay your calculations of the pattern of where to dig for maximum efficiency on the actual ground. Or you've just discovered one wall of a structure, and now want to extrapolate to see how far the wall might

run, and compare that with the topographical layout of the site...

EVERYTHING ELSE

Surely by now you can imagine a whole list of ways AR or ER can be useful going forth. As always write to us and tell us some of those suggestions. We'll give the most interesting ones some goodies and publish those suggestions as well.

BEYOND HMD / HUD

Yes, we hate wearing things on our heads. It's true. Heck, VR would probably have taken off much sooner if headsets were cool.



Some day this will be even more of an experience than it is already

It's only now with them becoming lighter with more pixels packed in and enough processing power to do realtime rendering that VR is garnering interest, however, whilst we're OK wearing a stupid headset to be taken deep into imaginary land, we're not going to be walking about the street with those ugly things on. Heck, even wearing Google Glass seems a little lame to some. So what's the hope for AR then?

Work is being done on contact lenses that can act as a display. It's still early stages, but then again what hasn't been? Then there's always your trusty phone / tablet / device that connects you to everything... it will definitely have a screen, and that can always be a portal to an enhanced reality. However, it may sound like science fiction, but we fully expect direct brain connections with technology to rule the roost. Maybe a simple and small skull cap can be used to interface you with technology, and thus show you whatever it is you want to know, without even needing to ask for it - just think it... When that happens, the next stage of evolution will have occurred for our species... thus the title... Augment me... 

WARPED REALITY IN MOVIES

The Matrix is one of the first few movies that was completely based on a hypothesis that reality can be simulated and showed us quite vividly how humans actually lived (or were virtualized) inside a simulated world not knowing of its existence whatsoever. Although, the idea that the universe that we live in can be simulated is quite chilling, it's also very interesting and scientists across the world are working towards turning it into a reality. According to the movie, the Matrix worked by providing a false sensory input directly to the central nervous system of connected individuals. Achieving this in reality is quite difficult as it isn't as simple as placing someone on a treadmill with screens all around as the someone in question should also feel or rather believe that the world that he's in is as real as it gets. By using a research area called Optogenetics, scientists have genetically engineered animals like roundworms and mice to have light-sensitive proteins in their brain by using lasers to zap a few of their neurons. By doing this, they were actually able to stimulate reward pathways in mice for some time. But all of this was done at a miniscule level which is nothing compared to what would be required for simulating a world for humans. What would most certainly bake your noodle is the possibility of us being actually inside a computer simulation right now but there is no way to know about it for sure. Or is there?